

VARSHA THAKUR

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SUMMARY

Master's candidate in Educational Innovation, Technology, and Entrepreneurship at the UNC School of Education and [Rotary Peace Fellow \(2025–27\)](#) at the Duke–UNC Rotary Peace Center. Education professional with 5+ years of experience in program coordination, research-informed writing, curriculum/resource creation, data tracking, and process improvement. Skilled in managing complex information, drafting clear stakeholder materials, publishing content on LMS, and supporting academic programs with strong attention to detail. Graduate coursework in statistics, design thinking, emerging technologies, and AI-supported prototyping. Currently interning with UNICEF Office of Internal Audit and Investigation (OIAI), New York.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- Education
- AI Literacy and Ethics
- Statistics
- Instructional Design
- Peace and Conflict Resolution
- Research
- Knowledge Management
- Human-centered design
- Communication

EDUCATION

- University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, School of Education, NC, US** expected May 2027
Master of Arts, Educational Innovation Technology and Entrepreneurship (MEITE)
Concentration: The Adaptive Learning Analyst track
Relevant Coursework: Statistics, Design of Emerging Technologies
- Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India** May 2016
Master of Arts, International Relations
Merit-cum-means scholarship (2014–2016)
Relevant Coursework: Principles of Economic Organization, International Organization
- University of Delhi, New Delhi, India** May 2014
Bachelor of Arts, Political Science (Honors)

WORK EXPERIENCE

- [UNICEF](#), New York, US** May 2026–Present
Intern- Office of Internal Audit and Investigation (OIAI)
 - Assist with the analysis of information and data related to initial assessments and/or investigations;
 - Research UNICEF systems and sources of information, open-source material for case assessments
 - Prepare draft case assessments, notes for the record, investigation, advisory and other reports
 - Leverage internal AI tools for transcripts, summary, and confidential information
- [NewGlobe Education](#), Hyderabad, India** 2019–2025
Deputy Managing Editor, Instructional Design, New Delhi, India (2023–2025)
 - Led a team of 10 associates and 2 managers
 - Co-authored Level A-C homework books for 1 M+ pupils in East and West Africa, and India
 - Trained the team on AI Prompt Engineering to standardize content and art generation
 - Reduced the cost of Kenya print products by 17.77 % by designing cost-effective full-year versions
 - Created process documents, internal training materials, capacity projections, and project trackers
 - Developed KPIs and success metrics to measure delivery quality, efficiency, and outcomes

Manager, Instructional Design, Hyderabad, India (2020–2023)

- Managed a team of 6 associates
- Led the instructional design team that created 800+ assessments for EdoBEST, a government of Edo and the World Bank program in Edo State, Nigeria
- Managed instructional design team for the STAR Education program (500+ teacher guides and 100+ term exams for Class 6–9)

Associate, Instructional Design, Hyderabad, India (2019–2020)

- Created 1200+ Teacher guides for Nigeria, Uganda, Liberia, Kenya, and India
- Designed 900+ radio lessons during the Covid-19 pandemic for continued learning in Africa
- Designed 450+ Hindi teacher guides and exams for Andhra Pradesh (Grades 3, 4, and 5)

Indian PAC, Uttar Pradesh, India

2016–2017

Junior Associate/ Political Analyst

- Designed 3 election campaigns for the assembly election in Uttar Pradesh and Punjab, India
- Conducted FGDs with community health workers, local journalists, and farmers
- Led field operations for election campaigns in 17 assembly constituencies
- Authored a comprehensive state report highlighting key issues faced by farmers and weavers

PUBLICATIONS

NSDC Connect, National Skill Development Corporation, New Delhi, India

April 2024

- "Towards a Brighter Future: Innovation and AI in the Education Sector." NSDC Connect, March 2024, pp. 21-23 [[link](#)]

NewGlobe Education, New Delhi, India

2023–2025

- Co-author of 9 Homework Books, Level A- C. These are foundational literacy and numeracy homework books with integrated QR codes for phonics practice

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Rotary Peace Fellowship Award:** Awarded a fully funded master's program with a stipend and professional development support by The Rotary Foundation
- **Books Delivery During Conflict:** Led the delivery of 4,747 tailored books to children living in military camps during the May 2023 ethnic conflict in Manipur, India
- **GenAI use process standardization:** Developed and rolled out AI usage standards and best practices across a 10-person content team, improving coordination and reducing revision cycles by 40%

LANGUAGES, COMPUTER SKILLS, AND SOFT SKILLS

- **Language Skills:** Hindi: Native; English: Fluent; Maithili: Native
- **Computer Skills:** R, Articulate storyline, Github, Figma, Canva, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, Generative AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Codex, Adobe Firefly, Gemini audio and video features)
- **Soft Skills:** Communication, Problem solving, Time management, Eye for detail
- **Management and leadership competencies:** Knowledge management, Stakeholder management, Team management, Performance evaluation

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Certifications:

- UNESCO Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Development (Teachers as Designers and Compassionate Integrity Training)
- Direct Instruction Lesson Design, NewGlobe: a comprehensive 120-hour-long course

US visa: F1 (STEM visa valid till May 2030)